FRANMARINE UNDERWATER SERVICES PTY LTD

LOSS OF STEERING

Emergency Procedure

MV SEAGULL | UVI: 425689

Marine Order 504 (2024) — Schedule 1 Compliance

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Review Frequency

This document shall be reviewed at least every 12 months, or sooner following a significant incident, change of operations, vessel modification, or change in applicable legislation.

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1. PURPOSE

This procedure establishes the actions to be taken in the event of a loss of steering on MV Seagull.

1.1 Regulatory Reference

Marine Order 504 (2024), Schedule 1, Clause 12.

1.2 Vessel Configuration

MV Seagull is fitted with a single Yamaha F150XD outboard engine and hydraulic steering. Where the vessel's survey or approval requires it (generally vessels 7.5 m and over), an emergency steering arrangement is provided. In the event of a steering system failure, the master shall reduce speed and use the emergency steering arrangement as fitted, or control the vessel's heading by the means available, to navigate to safety.

2. IMMEDIATE ACTIONS

- Reduce speed to idle immediately.
- Alert all crew to the loss of steering.
- Engage the vessel's emergency steering arrangement as fitted. If steering cannot be restored, control heading using available means and reduce way through the water.
- Assess for collision risk. If in a busy waterway or unable to maintain safe directional control, issue a SÉCURITÉ or PAN PAN call on VHF Ch 16 advising of the loss of steering and the vessel's position. Advise the relevant port authority (refer FUS-SMS-SGL-05J for VHF channels).

3. TROUBLESHOOTING

Common causes of steering failure on outboard vessels:

- Low hydraulic steering fluid — check the reservoir level and top up if possible.
- Hydraulic line failure — inspect visible hose runs for leaks or burst hoses.
- Steering cable disconnection — inspect the cable connection at the helm and at the outboard tiller arm.
- Obstruction at the outboard — check for rope, debris, or marine growth around the lower unit preventing the outboard from pivoting.
- Steering arm or connection failure — inspect the steering connection at the outboard for damage or disconnection.

If the fault can be identified and rectified safely, do so. If not, use the emergency steering arrangement to navigate to a safe location, or anchor and request assistance.

4. EMERGENCY STEERING AND NAVIGATION

If hydraulic steering is lost, MV Seagull shall be navigated using the emergency steering arrangement as fitted. The following principles apply:

- Operate the emergency steering arrangement (e.g. manual/emergency tiller) to direct the outboard.
- Keep speed low; the vessel will respond more slowly than under normal hydraulic steering.
- Make small, deliberate steering inputs and allow for the effects of wind and current on heading.
- If steering cannot be maintained at all, reduce engine to idle to minimise way through the water.
- Navigate to the nearest safe port, berth, or anchorage.
- If unable to maintain any directional control, deploy the anchor to arrest drift and prevent grounding or collision. Request a tow if necessary.

5. POST-INCIDENT

- Do not continue normal operations until steering is fully restored and tested.
- Report to the East Coast Operations Superintendent.
- Record all details in the vessel logbook.
- Arrange for repair by a qualified marine mechanic before the vessel returns to service.

6. REFERENCES

- FUS-SMS-SGL-06 Emergency Plan
- FUS-SMS-SGL-07 Maintenance
- Marine Order 504 (2024), Schedule 1, Clause 12